Table 1.1 Early concepts of unmanned aerial vehicles

Period/year	Development/ innovation	Developer/country	Key features/technological advancement
Before 1900	Tethered Balloons and Kites for Aerial Observation	France, the United Kingdom, and China	Used for early reconnaissance and weather observation; manually operated.
1916	*Aerial Target*	A. M. Low (United Kingdom)	Radio-controlled powered aircraft; experimental air defense drone.
1917	*Ruston Proctor Aerial Target*	Ruston Proctor Aircraft Co. (United Kingdom)	Small pilotless monoplane with early radio control.
1918	*Kettering Bug*	Charles Kettering (United States)	Unmanned aerial torpedo with pre-set mechanical control.
1935	*Queen Bee*	De Havilland Aircraft Co. (United Kingdom)	Radio-controlled biplane for military gunnery training.
1939–1945	*Radioplane OQ-2*	Reginald Denny Industries (United States)	Catapult-launched, radio-controlled target drone.
1950s	*Ryan Firebee Series*	*Ryan Aeronautical (United States)*	Jet-powered drone with long-range radio guidance.
1960s	*Ryan Model 147 "Lightning Bug"*	Ryan Aeronautical (United States)	Advanced reconnaissance UAV with camera payloads.
1970s	*IAI Scout* (Prototype Phase)	Israel Aerospace Industries (Israel)	Real-time video transmission and remote control.